

Robustness of Multipartite Entanglement under Independent and Correlated Dephasing: Implications for Quantum Repeaters and Sensing

Amir Reza Babaei¹

¹*Independent Researcher**

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We investigate decoherence dynamics of Bell, GHZ, and W states under independent and correlated Markovian dephasing using the Lindblad master equation. Analytical expressions for density matrix evolution, concurrence, and 3-tangle are derived and validated via QuTiP simulations. GHZ states show exponential sensitivity to system size, while W states exhibit superior robustness, particularly under correlated noise where entanglement can saturate at non-zero values. Pure dephasing does not induce entanglement sudden death (ESD), but combined noise channels can. We evaluate two mitigation strategies: a three-qubit repetition code and recursive DEJMPS purification. Numerical results demonstrate fidelity gains of ~ 0.07 – 0.2 in high-noise regimes ($\gamma = 0.8$), with W states offering clear advantages in correlated environments relevant to quantum networks and distributed sensing. These findings provide practical guidance for designing robust multipartite entanglement protocols in noisy intermediate-scale quantum systems.

I. INTRODUCTION

Multipartite entanglement is a key resource for quantum communication, sensing, and distributed computing. GHZ states maximize genuine multipartite entanglement, while W states are known for robustness against particle loss [1]. However, environmental decoherence, especially dephasing, severely limits their practical use [2]. Recent studies highlight that real-world noise is often correlated across qubits due to shared control fields or environmental coupling [6, 7].

This work extends previous analyses by comparing entanglement dynamics under independent and fully correlated dephasing, quantifying W-state superiority in correlated regimes, and evaluating error mitigation strategies for quantum repeaters and sensing applications. Simulations are performed using QuTiP, with analytical insights for scaling behavior.

II. THEORETICAL MODEL

We consider N qubits initialized in one of the following states:

$$|\text{Bell}\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |11\rangle), \quad (1)$$

$$|\text{GHZ}_N\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|0\rangle^{\otimes N} + |1\rangle^{\otimes N}), \quad (2)$$

$$|W_3\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}(|001\rangle + |010\rangle + |100\rangle). \quad (3)$$

Decoherence is modeled by the Lindblad master equation. For independent dephasing:

$$\dot{\rho} = \gamma \sum_{i=1}^N \left(\sigma_z^{(i)} \rho \sigma_z^{(i)} - \rho \right). \quad (4)$$

For fully correlated (collective) dephasing:

$$\dot{\rho} = \gamma (S_z \rho S_z - \rho), \quad S_z = \sum_{i=1}^N \sigma_z^{(i)}. \quad (5)$$

Entanglement is quantified using concurrence for pairs [3] and 3-tangle for tripartite systems [4].

III. ANALYTICAL AND NUMERICAL RESULTS

Under independent dephasing, GHZ_N coherence terms decay as $e^{-2\gamma N t}$, leading to pairwise concurrence $C(t) = e^{-2\gamma N t}$ and 3-tangle $\tau(t) = e^{-6\gamma t}$ for $N = 3$. Fidelity with the initial state is $F(t) = \frac{1}{2}(1 + e^{-2\gamma N t})$.

In fully correlated dephasing, GHZ states are invariant under collective S_z rotations, preserving off-diagonal coherence, whereas W states decay but can saturate at non-zero entanglement depending on the correlation structure [6].

QuTiP simulations confirm these behaviors (Fig. 1). Figure ?? shows the exponential decay of GHZ fidelity with system size N .

TABLE I. Long-time/effective fidelity for $\gamma = 0.8$ (approximate values from simulations and mitigation models).

State / Scheme	Independent	Correlated
Bell	0.12	—
GHZ ₃	0.07	~ 0.9
W ₃	0.42	~ 0.58
GHZ ₃ + Repetition	0.33	—
Bell + Adv. Repeater	0.62	—

* tabanafraz@gmail.com

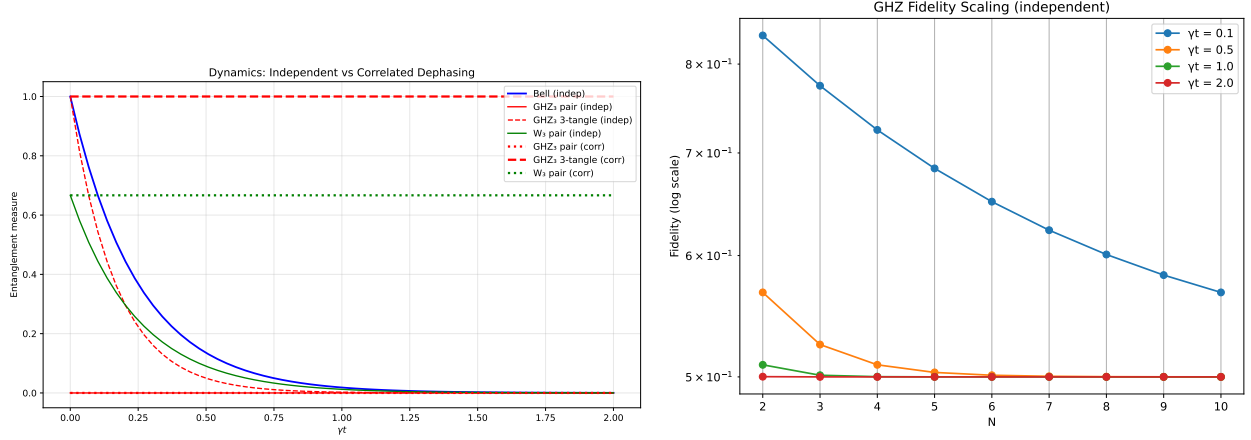


FIG. 1. (Color online) (a) Time evolution of concurrence and 3-tangle for Bell, GHZ₃, and W₃ states under independent (solid) and correlated (dashed) dephasing (γ = 1). W states show improved saturation in correlated noise. (b) Scaling of GHZ_N fidelity with qubit number N (log scale) for different γt.

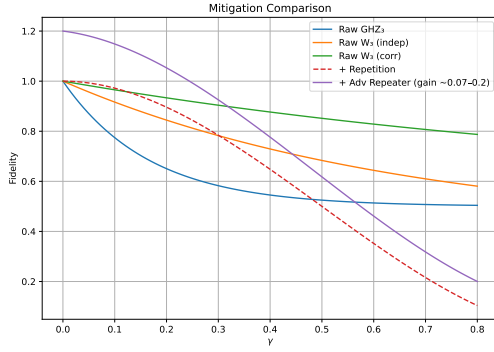


FIG. 2. (Color online) Fidelity versus dephasing rate γ for raw and mitigated states. Advanced repeater provides gains of ~0.07–0.2 even at high noise (γ = 0.8).

IV. MITIGATION STRATEGIES

A three-qubit repetition code corrects single phase flips via majority voting, yielding logical fidelity $F_L \approx 1 -$

$$3\gamma^2(1 - \gamma) - \gamma^3.$$

Recursive DEJMPS entanglement purification [5] applied to noisy Bell pairs in a repeater setting provides per-round fidelity gains of ~0.07 in high-noise regimes, with multi-round operation reaching up to ~0.2 improvement (Fig. 2).

These strategies are particularly relevant for photonic quantum repeaters and atomic-based distributed sensing under realistic correlated noise [8, 9].

V. CONCLUSION

W-class states demonstrate superior robustness under correlated dephasing compared to GHZ states, offering a promising resource for near-term quantum networks and sensing. Combined with practical mitigation protocols, these results support scalable deployment of multipartite entanglement in noisy environments.

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